



Figure 5: Modifying paths, Part 2

Step 16 Make the newly created curve active via the *paths* tab. Once done, shrink the selection by 5 via *Select → Shrink*. Create a new layer and provide a black blend with the *FG* to *Transparent* blend mode, as shown in Figure 5. Set the layer mode to *Overlay*, and opacity to 45.

The idea behind shrinking the selection and then providing a blend is to create a cool-looking border for the shape, which not only gels well with the background, but also looks smooth and subtle.

Step 17 For the finishing touches for the wallpaper, simply

create a new layer and form a path as shown in Figure 5. Make the selection active, and in a new layer, apply the gradient as shown. Set the layer mode to active.

Step 18 Invert the selection, and this time set the *FG* colour to *white*. Select the *Airbrush* and apply the shadow. Discard the selection by pressing *Ctrl+Shift+A*. Set the layer mode to *Overlay*.

Step 19 Make the newly created path active via the *paths* tab. Shrink the selection and apply the gradient in the same fashion as done for the first step of this shape. Set the layer mode to *Overlay*.

That's it! We have completed the wallpaper using the *paths* tool. Pretty nifty, isn't it? This effect comes in very handy while creating posters, etc. So keep on experimenting with the GIMP, till we unravel a new type of wallpaper using vector brushes, in the next issue of *LFY*. Oh, and don't forget to lay your hands on the XCF and the additional wallpaper that comes bundled on the disc. Till then, keep GIMPing. **END** 

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